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ASIA WEEK AHEAD AUSTRALIA CHINA

Asia week ahead: RBA decision, key data on China, Japan, Korea, Indonesia

The Reserve Bank of Australia is expected to raise interest rates by 25bp, while investors will also be closely watching China's PMI data, activity and inflation readings from Japan and South Korea, and Indonesia's latest CPI report



Asia Research highlights of the week

[Xi-Trump summit: Pandas and positive vibes but limited progress](#)

[Bank Indonesia holds, but the hiking cycle may not be over](#)

[Oil, not El Niño, is driving Singapore inflation](#)

Australia: RBA expected to hike rates by 25bp

We expect the Reserve Bank of Australia RBA to deliver a decisive 25bp rate hike on Tuesday, reflecting an economy that continues to run hot across multiple fronts. Labour market

conditions remain tight, second-quarter GDP growth surprised to the upside, and recent inflation readings came in stronger than expected. While the housing market shows signs of cooling, we expect the RBA to emphasise that risks remain tilted to the upside and further vigilance is required to ensure prices return sustainably to target.

Separately, August CPI data is likely to accelerate further to 4.1% year-on-year, driven primarily by higher diesel and food prices, alongside persistent underlying core inflation pressures.

China: PMIs expected to slow a modest recovery

China releases September purchasing managers' index data on Wednesday. We look for the National Bureau of Statistics to report a slight recovery in its official manufacturing and non-manufacturing PMIs to 50.1 and 49.2, respectively. The RatingDog PMI, which has generally outperformed lately because of its more export-oriented sample, is out the same day. Industrial profits data is out Monday. Growth in the series has been moderating over the past 3 months, even as overall profits have improved from previous years.

Japan: Activity and inflation data in focus

Japan releases its August services PPI on Monday. Market consensus is for services inflation to remain unchanged at 3.6% YoY, indicating that price pressures in the sector remain firm. Retail sales growth is expected to moderate to 3.2% YoY, from 4.0% in July. Sales are forecast to decline 0.9% month-on-month after the previous month's 2.4% increase. Industrial production is expected to rebound 1.4% MoM, lifting annual growth to 7.0% YoY from 3.9%. The quarterly Tankan survey is expected to show improvement in business sentiment among large manufacturers. The index is expected to rise to 25 from 22, while the outlook is seen rising to 22 from 17.

Tokyo inflation data will be released on Friday. Market consensus is for headline inflation to accelerate to 2.5% YoY, from 1.9%, while core prices rise to 2.4%, from 1.8%. This pickup would suggest that price pressures remain elevated.

South Korea: Trade surplus to widen as inflation eases

South Korea releases August industrial production data on Wednesday. Market consensus expects industrial production growth to accelerate to 4.5% YoY, from 3.6% in July. Monthly output is forecast to rise 0.5%. September trade data, out Thursday, is expected to show a moderation in both export and import growth to 61.2% YoY and 20.7% YoY, respectively. Despite slower growth, the trade surplus is forecast to widen to \$38.4bn, supported by continued strength in technology and semiconductor exports. Headline CPI inflation is expected to ease to 3.0% YoY in September, from 3.1% in August. Core inflation is forecast to slow more sharply to 2.8% YoY, from 3.4%.

Indonesia: Inflation set to accelerate on food pressures

We expect Indonesia's CPI inflation to accelerate to 3.3% YoY, as El Niño drives further increases in food prices. Rising rice prices should remain a key driver, while spillovers from higher food costs are also likely to add to core inflation.

Key events in Asia next week

Country	Time (GMT+8)	Data/event	ING	
Monday 28 September				
Japan	0750	Aug PPI services (YoY%)	CF: 3.6	3.6
China	0930	Aug Industrial Profits (YTD YoY%)		17.6
India	1830	Aug Industrial Output (YoY%)	7,5	6,7
Tuesday 29 September				
Japan	1300	Jul Leading Indicator Revised	-	117,9
Australia	1230	Rate Decision	4,6	4,35
South Korea	0500	Sep Business Confidence	-	81
Wednesday 30 September				
Japan	0750	Aug Retail Sales (MoM%/YoY%)	CF: -0.9/3.2	2.4/4
	0750	Aug Industrial Output Prelim (MoM%/YoY%)	CF:1.4/7.0	-0.2/3.9
	1300	Aug Housing Starts (YoY%)	CF:7	8,2
Australia	0930	Aug Inflation Rate (MoM%/YoY%)	0.6/4.1	1/3.5
China	0930	Sep NBS Manufacturing PMI	50.1	49,8
	0930	Sep NBS Non-Manufacturing PMI	49.2	49
	0945	Sep RatingDog Manufacturing PMI	-	51,5
	0945	Sep RatingDog Services PMI	-	51,4
Malaysia	1500	Aug Money Supply (YoY%)	-	5,7
Philippines	0900	Aug Imports (YoY%)	19	19,8
	0900	Aug Exports (YoY%)	12,5	10,8
	0900	Aug Trade Balance (USD mn)	-5300	-5973
Thailand	1500	Aug Current Account Balance (USD bn)	-	-1,6
	1530	Jul Retail Sales (YoY%)	-	-18,3
South Korea	0700	Aug Industrial Output (MoM%/YoY%)	CF:0.5/4.5	0.2/3.6
	0700	Aug Retail Sales (MoM%)	-	-2,4
Thursday 1 October				
Japan	0750	Q3 Tankan Large Manufacturers Index	CF:25	22
	0750	Q3 Tankan Large Mfg outlook	CF:22	17
	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI Final	-	54,9
India	1300	Sep HSBC Manufacturing PMI Final	-	52,8
Malaysia	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	50,2
Indonesia	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	49,8
	1200	Sep CPI (MoM%/YoY%)	0.3/3,3	0.2/3.2
	1200	Sep Core CPI (YoY%)	2,9	2,9
	1200	Aug Trade Balance (USD bn)	0,7	0,1
	1200	Aug Exports Growth (YoY%)	4	6,1
	1200	Aug Imports Growth (YoY%)	28	27
Philippines	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	54,9
Taiwan	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	54,7
Thailand	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	53,8
South Korea	0800	Sep Exports (YoY%)	CF:61.2	68,7
	0800	Sep Imports (YoY%)	CF:20.7	22,5
	0800	Sep Trade Balance (USD bn)	CF:38.4	34,8
	0830	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	-	52,3
Friday 2 October				
Japan	0730	Aug Unemployment Rate	CF:2.4	2,4
	0730	Sep Tokyo CPI (YoY%)	CF:2.5	1,9
	0730	Sep Tokyo Core CPI (YoY%)	CF:2.4	1,8
	1300	Sep Consumer Confidence	-	35,5
Hong Kong	1630	Aug Retail Sales (YoY%)	-	2,3
South Korea	0700	Sep CPI (MoM%/YoY%)	CF:0.4/3.0	0.2/3.1
	0700	Sep Core CPI (YoY%)	CF:2.8	3,4
Singapore	2100	Sep Manufacturing PMI	-	51,5
India	1930	FX Reserves (USD bn)	-	780,8

Note: CF=market consensus forecast data

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